



in 1776, immigrants started to arrive in enormous numbers, attracted by a better life, or the “American Dream.” Today, the United States still accepts about one million immigrants annually. The mix of cultures has

enriched the country and has become its defining quality. In cities such as New York, pockets of established ethnic communities manage to maintain the culture of their homeland as well lead American lives.



HISPANIC COMMUNITY

Twelve percent of the US population is Hispanic, which means they, or their ancestors, came to the US from Mexico, Spain, Puerto Rico, or one of the other countries in South or Central America. This young girl holds a Puerto Rican flag while participating in Chicago's Puerto Rico Day Parade.

CHINATOWN

By the 1880s the Chinese began to arrive, attracted by available jobs—many built the railroads out to the West. Today over 80,000 Chinese-Americans live in New York City in an area known as Chinatown, which has remained a self-contained community with countless restaurants and seven Chinese newspapers.



AMERICAN JEWS

The first Jewish immigrants in the United States are said to have arrived around 1650. During the late 1800s Jews began to move in substantial numbers to the United States from Europe and Asia. Today, there are about 5.5 million Jews in the country. The largest synagogue in the world is the Temple Emanu-El on the Upper East Side, New York City.

ITALIAN-AMERICANS

The first Italians, many of them from northern Italy, arrived in the US in the 1830s and 1840s. Later, during the 1870s, poverty forced many more to move. Over 11 days each September, about three million people converge on the neighborhood known as Little Italy in New York City for the Feast of San Gennaro—a massive festival to celebrate the patron saint of Naples, Italy.

